

Wonderstorm Academy — Photography Shot List

For Brittany • shoot day at the school • prepared 2 Sep 2026

The brief in one line

The website currently sells a **Socratic, learner-driven** school using stock photography of **teacher-fronted classrooms**. Every frame below exists to replace that contradiction with the real thing: children running their own learning, adults beside them rather than in front of them.

Before the shutter: two things to settle with Holly

1. **Photo releases for every child in frame.** A school shoot with minors

needs signed parental consent, and it needs to be signed *before* the day, not chased afterwards. Ask Holly to send her existing release form; if she doesn't have one, that is a five-minute item to solve on Friday.

1. **Which children are cleared.** Some families opt out. Ask Holly to name

them at the start of the day so nothing has to be discarded later.

Technical specs

SPEC	VALUE	WHY
Orientation	Landscape for everything except portraits	Every crop on the site is landscape
Crops the site uses	21:9, 16:9, 3:2, 4:3, and 1:1	Shoot wide and loose so all five can be cut from one frame
Hero frames	Subject right of centre , quiet space on the left third	A dark gradient and white headline sit over the left side
Resolution	Largest your camera offers, unedited RAW + JPEG	Some frames are used full-bleed at 2× on retina
Files	Deliver flat, original filenames	Renaming happens on our side

Shoot every setup wide. A tight frame can be cropped out of a wide one; the reverse is not true, and five different aspect ratios have to come from the same take.

Priority 1 — THE ROOMS

Added after Jack walked the building: "complete freedom in there for the children, and it's very stimulating. All the rooms are different."

That last sentence is the website. A room-by-room walkthrough is something no competitor can copy, because it is a fact about their building rather than a claim about their philosophy. But it only works if the frames **sequence** — and that is decided at the shutter, not afterwards.

Shoot every distinct room the same way:

Height	Same eye height every time — roughly standing adult, and keep it consistent
Lens	One focal length for the whole set. Do not zoom between rooms
Angle	From the doorway or a corner, showing the <i>whole</i> room
Frames per room	Two: one empty, one in use
Order	Shoot them in the order you'd walk them, and note that order

Empty rooms show the design. Rooms in use show the freedom. We need both, and they must be the same room from the same spot so one can dissolve into the other on the page.

Count the rooms first, then shoot all of them. A walkthrough that skips two rooms isn't a walkthrough.

Priority 2 — the pages with no photograph at all

These four have literally nothing. They are the easiest, biggest wins.

1. The building, arriving. (for `/visit` and the homepage) Golden hour. A parent and child walking toward the entrance, seen from behind. The **Wonderstorm Academy sign must be legible** in frame. Landscape, wide. → *This is the single most valuable frame of the day.*

2. A student running a session. (for `/platform` — 4,700px of text, no image) A child standing, leading; other children seated and engaged; the adult visibly **off to the side or seated among them, not at the front**. This frame is the whole pitch in one picture.

3. An expedition in progress. (for `/atlas` — the curriculum page) Real project work in the middle of happening; materials out, hands busy, several children on one problem. Mess is good. Staged tidiness is not.

4. Children resolving something between themselves. (for `/calibration`, the S.O.S. page) Two or three children mid-conversation — negotiating, disagreeing, working it out. No adult in frame. This page is about social skill and currently has nothing to show for it.

Priority 3 — long bare stretches on strong pages

5. Open Circle / morning discussion — children in a circle, a child leading, adult seated in the ring. (`/day`, `/method`)

6. Independent reading or quiet work — beanbags, floor, window light.

(`/los` — the digital home base page, 5,100px bare)

7. A child at a screen, working — the Leader Portal in use, over the shoulder. Screen content does not need to be legible. (`/los`, `/portal`)

8. **The four flights / mixed ages** — older and younger children working together. (/studios — *the page is built around "Four flights."*)

9. **Making and building** — tools, materials, prototypes, hands.

(/method , /learning)

10. **Something finished, being presented** — a child showing work to peers.

(/apply , /atlas)

Priority 4 — people and place

11. **Holly, working.** Not a headshot — Holly *in the room*, mid-conversation with a child. Warm, unposed.

12. **Dave, the same.**

13. **Holly and Dave together**, if they will sit for it.

14. **The coaches** — one usable frame each, environmental.

15. **Details** — a wall of student work, a hand-written board, materials on a shelf, the emblem on a door. Shoot ten of these; they fill small gaps for years.

What NOT to shoot

- **An adult lecturing at a whiteboard to rows of seated children.** This is

the exact image the current site uses and it contradicts everything the school says about itself. It is the reason for the shoot.

- **Any other school's or company's signage in frame.** One current photo has

"microSchool" on the wall behind the subjects.

- **Posed rows.** Line-ups read as a class photo, not a school in motion.
- **Empty-eyed compliance.** Children looking at the camera on request. We want

them looking at their work and at each other.

- Anything with a child who is not release-cleared, however good the frame.
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The test for every frame

Could this photograph be from any school in America?

If yes, it is not the shot. Wonderstorm's claim is that the children run the place. Each frame should be evidence for that claim, not decoration around it.